AERONIQX

INDIA EXPORT-REGISTRATION STARTER

Set up your export business

A practical registration sequence, document checklist and fee reference, using banana leaves as the example.

- IEC, GST/LUT, APEDA and bank-account setup
- Product and destination checks before shipment
- Official links, application folder and handoff template



Public-source edition | Checked 1 November 2026

@waititsashish

01 / DECIDE YOUR ROUTE

Define the product first

Registrations depend on what you sell, what you do and who exports it.

Your role	What to establish
Domestic supplier	You invoice an Indian exporter. Agree who handles export documents and overseas delivery.
Merchant exporter	You buy and export under your business name. Prepare the registrations and shipment checks in this guide.
Processor / manufacturer	You also process or manufacture. Additional premises, activity and product requirements may apply.

Write a one-paragraph product brief

State the botanical identity, fresh/frozen/dried form, whole or cut size, any treatment, intended use, origin, destination and expected shipment value. For example: fresh cut banana leaves for serving food, sourced in Tamil Nadu, supplied to a named importer in Great Britain.

Get the classification in writing

Ask a customs broker to confirm the applicable Indian ITC(HS) code, current export policy and required permissions. Ask the destination importer to confirm import conditions. This guide deliberately gives no universal HS code or tax rate for every leaf format.

General preparation guidance, not a product-specific legal or tax opinion. Rules and portal screens can change; confirm the current requirements for your consignment.

Sources: Foreign Trade Policy, chapter 2

02 / IEC

Apply for your exporter code

IEC means Importer Exporter Code. For ordinary commercial goods exports, it is the starting registration, subject to policy exemptions.

Keep these ready

PAN-linked identity and business details; proof of business address; a cancelled cheque showing the entity name or a prescribed bank certificate. Where address proof belongs to someone else, prepare the owner's consent and supporting proof as required.

Application sequence

1. Go to DGFT. Register as an importer/exporter using an accessible email and mobile.

2. Choose **Apply for IEC**. Validate PAN/name and the relevant birth or incorporation date.

3. Enter entity, address, proprietor/partner/director and bank details. Add GST details if applicable.

4. Upload the requested documents. Complete the declaration and DSC or Aadhaar e-sign step offered by the portal.

5. Pay the **₹500 government application fee**, retain the reference and track the application.

6. After approval and successful bank validation, download and check the issued IEC certificate.

Success check

The issued certificate must show the correct entity and details. A payment receipt alone is not an IEC. Bank validation or a mismatch can delay issue; do not promise a fixed completion time.

Sources: DGFT Handbook, chapter 2 · DGFT IEC manual V4.1 · DGFT official fee schedule

03 / GST AND LUT

Confirm the tax route

Ask your CA to assess the actual product and business activities before choosing registrations.

GST registration is a decision, not a guess

The CGST Act distinguishes taxable activities from businesses dealing exclusively in wholly exempt or non-taxable supplies. Do not assume every banana-leaf trader has the same GST position. Get the classification and registration requirement confirmed for your facts.

If registration is required, apply through gst.gov.in and retain the registration certificate. Prepare entity, authorised-signatory, business-address and bank evidence requested by the live application.

LUT: when the registered export route needs it

An eligible GST-registered exporter using the route for export without payment of IGST can furnish a Letter of Undertaking (LUT). Confirm eligibility and the correct route with your CA.

Portal steps

Login → **Services** → **User Services** → **Furnish Letter of Undertaking (LUT)**. Select the financial year, complete the declarations and witness details, choose the authorised signatory, and submit using the available signing method. Save the ARN and acknowledgement.

Record your decision

Product classification: _____
GST required / reason: _____
LUT applicable / financial year: _____
Reviewed by / date: _____

Sources: CGST Act, sections 23 and 24 · GST portal LUT walkthrough

04 / PRODUCT REGISTRATIONS

Check APEDA and FSSAI

Apply for the registrations that cover your actual product and activity.

APEDA / the correct export council

If APEDA covers the scheduled product, e-RCMC applications go through **DGFT → Services → e-RCMC** after IEC. Its published document list asks merchant exporters for a signed/sealed IEC; manufacturers also provide relevant manufacturing proof. Published registration fee: **₹5,900 including GST**; validity: **5 years**.

A change to check before paying

DGFT Notification 36 of **15 September 2026** exempts consignments with FOB value up to **₹3 lakh** from the RCMC requirement under FTP 2.57(a) and (b). Do not interpret this as cancelling separate statutory requirements. Ask APEDA whether your leaf product is covered and whether registration still applies under its Act.

FSSAI: establish whether the activity is covered

For a covered food business, the April 2026 FoSCoS table places Trader/Merchant Exporters in the Central Licence category without a turnover threshold and lists ₹7,500. Do not automatically apply that classification to non-edible leaves sold as food-contact material; confirm the product and activity with FSSAI.

Udyam: an optional MSME registration where eligible. Official registration is free; it does not replace export permissions.

Sources: APEDA e-RCMC documents and fees · APEDA annual report 2024-25 · DGFT Notification 36, 15 Sep 2026 · FoSCoS eligibility, April 2026 · Official Udyam registration guidance

05 / BANK AND CUSTOMS

Connect your export bank account

AD means Authorised Dealer. Your bank and ICEGATE records must refer to the same business.

First, ask your bank

Confirm that the account can receive export proceeds and ask for the relevant AD code. Have the bank align its entity name, PAN, IEC, account, IFSC and authorised branch records with your registrations.

Then, use the current ICEGATE workflow

Register/login at ICEGATE. In the October 2026 manual the path is **Profile status → Bank Account → Foreign Remittance Account (Authorised Dealer Code) → Add New Bank Account**.

Enter the AD code, retrieve bank/branch details, enter the account and customs location, then verify and submit. Follow the applicable bank route below. Confirm with your broker that the account is usable for your intended shipment location.

Bank route	What the October 2026 guidance says
API-integrated	Electronic bank verification; supporting-document upload and IRN are not required in that route.
Not integrated	Follow the document-upload workflow and its current proof requirements.
Verification fails	Check the entered details, then ask the bank to correct its records. ICEGATE cannot override a bank mismatch.

The incentive/refund bank-account setup is separate from the foreign-remittance account. Complete it if relevant to the claims you plan to make. Keep acknowledgements and verify status before submitting a duplicate request.

Sources: ICEGATE bank manual v1.02 · ICEGATE advisory, 1 Oct 2026

06 / PLANT HEALTH

Prepare the consignment checks

A phytosanitary certificate is a shipment document when required, not a one-time business registration.

Start with destination requirements

Ask the importer for the exact plant-health conditions for your leaf form and origin. Establish required declarations, inspection, testing or treatment with the Plant Quarantine authority before dispatch. Do not assume a treatment is acceptable merely because a supplier offers it.

India: application preparation

Use the official Plant Quarantine Management System for exporter registration and the applicable certificate application. The registration screen includes IEC verification, entity/contact details and the relevant Plant Quarantine station. Follow the station's current document and inspection requirements.

Prepare to share	Why it helps
Exact product description	Fresh/cut/frozen/dried form, botanical identity and intended use.
Shipment details	Exporter, consignee, origin, quantity, packing and route.
Import conditions	Importer's written requirements and any authority correspondence.
Inspection access	Where the lot is held and when it can be inspected.

Before booking freight: obtain the station's fees, inspection timing and any treatment requirements. There is no universal certificate cost or turnaround time quoted here.

Sources: India Plant Quarantine Management System · PQMS exporter registration

07 / GREAT BRITAIN EXAMPLE

Confirm the importer’s side

This example covers England, Scotland and Wales. Northern Ireland has a separate route.

Get a written answer for banana leaves

Give the importer the precise description, such as fresh cut Musa leaves from India for serving food. Ask it to confirm the risk category with APHA or the relevant authority. A rule for banana fruit should not be assumed to cover banana leaves.

GOV.UK’s commercial plant-import guidance distinguishes risk categories: high and medium A goods require registration/notification and phytosanitary documentation; medium B goods require phytosanitary documentation. Conditions and checks depend on category. The guide also covers commercial imports by post or courier.

Message to the buyer / importer

Please confirm the import conditions for [exact product, form, origin and intended use].

Who is the importer of record? What risk category applies? Is a phytosanitary certificate needed, and with what declarations? Are IPAFFS notification, a specified entry point, inspection or packaging conditions required?

Please confirm who arranges clearance, pays destination charges and receives the goods if there is a delay.

This pack does not assign a Great Britain risk category to banana leaves or guarantee admission. Check the product-specific answer before sending even a commercial sample.

Sources: GOV.UK commercial plant imports

08 / FEES AND UPKEEP

Budget for the correct route

Guide price and government fees are separate. Check the amount displayed on the official portal before paying.

Item	Published fee / condition
New IEC	₹500 government application fee.
Annual IEC update	₹0 in April-June; ₹200 for annual update after that window in the cited fee schedule.
APEDA e-RCMC	₹5,900 including GST, if applicable; published renewal fee is also ₹5,900.
FSSAI central licence	₹7,500 listed for a covered Trader/Merchant Exporter; confirm the applicable period and final portal charge.
Udyam	Free official registration, where eligible.
Variable costs	Bank, broker, certificates, testing, treatment, handling, packing, freight and professional assistance: obtain quotes.

Put the dates in your calendar

Confirm or update IEC details every **April-June**, even if unchanged. Missing the annual update can lead to deactivation. Keep the acknowledgement and verify status after updating.

Keep separate reminders for any financial-year LUT, certificate expiry and renewal. Check source pages again before the next shipment or when your product, premises, entity or destination changes.

Sources: DGFT official fee schedule · DGFT annual IEC update rule · APEDA e-RCMC documents and fees · FoSCoS eligibility, April 2026 · Official Udyam registration guidance · GST portal LUT walkthrough

09 / APPLICATION FOLDER

Keep evidence in one place

Use these folder names so you can hand the same organised set to your CA, bank and broker.

Folder	Put inside
01 Identity	PAN-linked entity details, constitution documents and signatory authorisation as applicable.
02 Address	Accepted address proof and owner consent where needed.
03 Bank	Cancelled cheque / bank certificate, AD details and bank confirmations.
04 Registrations	Issued IEC; GST, LUT, e-RCMC and other certificates only where applicable.
05 Product decision	Written classification, export-policy check and the destination import conditions.
06 Shipment	Buyer order, supplier specification, invoice, packing and transport details.
07 Follow-up	Portal acknowledgements, deficiency replies, inspection results and renewal reminders.

Standard goods-export documents

FTP paragraph 2.06 lists the transport document (such as air waybill or bill of lading), commercial invoice-cum-packing list, and shipping bill/bill of export. Separate invoice and packing list are accepted. Product-specific laws may require additional documents.

Sources: DGFT Handbook, chapter 2 · Foreign Trade Policy, chapter 2

10 / SEND THIS TO YOUR BROKER

A useful first handoff

Fill the blanks after you have a buyer and a clear product specification.

Subject: requirements for proposed banana-leaf export

We plan to export [fresh whole / cut / frozen / dried] banana leaves from [Indian dispatch point] to [destination]. Intended use is [use]. Treatment, if any: [details]. Proposed quantity and value: [details].

Our role is [merchant exporter / manufacturer]. We have [issued IEC and other applicable registrations]. The importer is [legal name/contact].

Please confirm in writing:
1. Correct ITC(HS) classification and current export policy.
2. Product/council, GST and other registration requirements for this transaction.
3. Bank-account/customs readiness and required documents.
4. Plant-health and destination requirements to coordinate with the importer.
5. Your itemised charges, excluded costs and cut-off dates.

Please identify any unresolved item that would prevent shipment.

Ready to proceed when...

• The required registrations are issued and the bank/customs setup is accepted.

• The buyer, broker and relevant authorities have resolved product and destination requirements.

• The supplier’s trial, packing plan, cost sheet and responsibilities are agreed in writing.

Keep the resulting written answers with the transaction. This template is an original preparation tool, not a substitute for the broker’s or authority’s determination.

OFFICIAL SOURCE DESK

Open the original guidance (1/2)

Links were checked on 1 November 2026. Recheck the live portal and later amendments before acting.

DGFT IEC manual V4.1

Application workflow, signing, bank validation and certificate download.

DGFT Handbook, chapter 2

IEC supporting documents and handbook procedures.

Foreign Trade Policy, chapter 2

Base policy on goods exports, IEC and standard shipment documents; read with later amendments.

DGFT official fee schedule

Official fee schedule. Portal charges should be checked at payment.

DGFT annual IEC update rule

Annual IEC confirmation/update rule and deactivation.

CGST Act, sections 23 and 24

Registration exceptions and compulsory-registration provisions; apply to your facts.

GST portal LUT walkthrough

LUT form, financial-year selection and submission workflow.

APEDA e-RCMC documents and fees

e-RCMC route, supporting documents, fees and validity.

APEDA annual report 2024-25

APEDA’s description of registration for scheduled-product exporters.

OFFICIAL SOURCE DESK

Open the original guidance (2/2)

Links were checked on 1 November 2026. Recheck the live portal and later amendments before acting.

DGFT Notification 36, 15 Sep 2026

FOB-value exemption from the specified FTP RCMC requirements.

FoSCoS eligibility, April 2026

Current business-category eligibility table; scope must be established.

Official Udyam registration guidance

Official free MSME-registration information.

ICEGATE bank manual v1.02

October 2026 account-registration screens and bank routes.

ICEGATE advisory, 1 Oct 2026

October 2026 bank-data matching and electronic verification advice.

India Plant Quarantine Management System

Plant-health application and certificate services.

PQMS exporter registration

Exporter registration fields and IEC verification.

GOV.UK commercial plant imports

Commercial plant-import controls for Great Britain; category-specific rules.